
● TEMPLATES · 12 PITCHES · SUBJECT LINES · RULES

Journalist *Pitch* Email Templates

Twelve pitch emails for the situations founders actually face, from exclusive offers to the follow-up nobody wants to write. Each is short on purpose. Reporters decide in the preview pane, so the first two lines carry the whole pitch.

THREE RULES BEFORE YOU SEND ANYTHING

1. Read the last three pieces the reporter wrote. If you cannot say why your story fits their beat in one line, do not pitch them.
2. One reporter per outlet per story. Pitching two people at the same publication at once burns both.
3. Personalise the first line every time. The rest of the template can stay close to as-is.

BEST FOR

Founders and in-house comms pitching tech, crypto, AI and security press

LENGTH

Every template is under 150 words. Keep it that way.

PAIRS WITH

Media List Template (.xlsx) and the Press Kit template

FORMULAS

Subject lines that get opened

The subject line is a headline the reporter could almost use. Specific nouns, a number if you have one, no hype. Under 70 characters so it survives mobile.

FORMULA	PATTERN	EXAMPLE SHAPE
Exclusive	Exclusive: [Company] [verb] [specific thing]	Exclusive: [Co] raises [\$X] to [do specific thing]
Data	[Number] [surprising finding] (new data)	[N] of [M] [audited protocols] [shared one flaw]: new data
Reactive	Re: [today's news], [expert] can explain [specific angle]	Re: [the exploit], ex-[role] on why [specific mechanism]
Embargo	Embargoed [date]: [news in 8 words]	Embargoed Tue 9am ET: [Co] opens [X] to [audience]
Trend	[Trend] is [moving], here is who is doing it	[Category] teams are quietly [doing X]; 3 founders on why
Contrarian	Op-ed idea: why [common belief] is wrong	Op-ed: why [common practice] makes [outcome] worse
Follow-up	Keep the original subject, add one new fact	Re: [original] + [new customer / number]

DO

- Lead with the news, then why it fits their beat.
- Offer something only you can give: data, access, a founder with a real opinion, a customer who will talk.
- Put links in the body, attachments only when asked.
- Say clearly if it is exclusive, embargoed or open.
- Send Tuesday to Thursday, in the reporter's morning.
- Follow up once, with something new.
- Respect "not for me". Note it in your media list.

DON'T

- Open with "I hope this email finds you well" or your company history.
- Bcc a list or mail-merge without changing the first line.
- Pitch the same story to two reporters at one outlet.
- Call it "revolutionary", "first-ever" or "leading" without proof.
- Offer an exclusive you have already promised elsewhere.
- Ask to see the article before it runs, or ask for edits after.
- Follow up more than twice. Ever.

01 · Exclusive offer

SEND T-12 TO T-10 · ONE REPORTER ONLY

Subject: Exclusive: [Company] [news in 8 words]

Hi [First name],

Your piece on [recent article, specific point] is why I am coming to you first. [Company] is announcing [news in one sentence] on [date], and I would like to offer you the exclusive.

What you would get: [founder interview, data not shared elsewhere, customer on record, early product access].

Why it matters for your readers: [one line connecting to their beat].

Could you let me know by [day, time TZ]? If it is not a fit, no problem, and I will take it elsewhere.

[Name]

The deadline is a courtesy, not pressure: it tells them you will not hold the story forever and you will not shop it while they decide.

02 · Embargoed launch

SEND T-10 TO T-5 · SMALL GROUP

Subject: Embargoed [Day Date, Time TZ] : [news in 8 words]

Hi [First name],

[Company] is launching [product] on [date]: [what it does for whom, one sentence]. Given your coverage of [topic], I thought it might be useful.

The interesting part is [the non-obvious angle: a design choice, a data point, a customer].

Would you accept the embargo? If yes, I will send the release, data and images, and can set up 20 minutes with [founder] this week.

[Name]

Ask before sending embargoed details. Only send the materials after they agree.

03 · Funding announcement

SEND T-10 · EXCLUSIVE OR EMBARGO

Subject: [Company] raises [\$X] [round] to [specific plan]

Hi [First name],

[Company] has raised [\$X round] led by [investor], announcing [date]. The money matters less than what it is for: [the specific bet, e.g. a product line, a market, a technical milestone].

Context you might find useful: [traction you will share on record, with date], and [why investors backed this now, in one line].

[Founder] and [lead investor partner] are both available to talk. Would an exclusive or embargoed briefing be of interest?

[Name]

04 · Data or research pitch

ANY TIME · STRONGEST EVERGREEN PITCH

Subject: [Number + finding] (new data)

Hi [First name],

We analysed [dataset: size, period, method in one line] and found [headline finding].

Two more findings that may interest your readers:

- [finding 2]
- [finding 3]

The full methodology and raw charts are here: [link]. Happy to share the underlying data under embargo until [date], and [analyst/founder] can walk you through it.

[Name]

State the method and sample honestly, including the limitations. Reporters trust data more when you tell them what it does not show.

05 · Reactive / newsjack

WITHIN HOURS OF THE NEWS

Subject: Re: [today's story], [expert credential] available

Hi [First name],

If you are following [news event]: [Expert, title] [relevant credential, e.g. has audited X / built Y] and can speak to [the specific angle most coverage is missing].

Their take in two lines: "[quotable, specific view]"

Available by phone or email for the next [hours]. Feel free to use the quote above with attribution.

[Name] · [phone]

Speed and specificity win. Never newsjack a tragedy, a victim's loss or an exploit to sell your product; offer expertise, not a pitch.

06 · Founder op-ed pitch

TO OPINION OR CONTRIBUTED-CONTENT EDITORS

Subject: Op-ed idea: [the argument in a sentence]

Hi [First name],

I would like to propose an op-ed by [Founder, title] arguing that [contrarian or under-discussed thesis].

The piece would cover: [point 1], [point 2], and [what readers should do differently]. It is not about [Company]; it draws on [their specific experience].

About 800 words, exclusive to [outlet], ready within [days] of a yes. Previous writing: [link].

[Name]

07 · Podcast guest pitch

TO HOST OR PRODUCER

Subject: Guest idea for [Show] : [episode title idea]

Hi [First name],

I enjoyed your episode with [guest], especially [specific moment]. It made me think [Founder] could add a different angle.

Three episode ideas:

1. [Specific story or lesson]
2. [Opinion your audience will argue with]
3. [Practical how-to]

[Founder] [one-line credibility]. Recent talk: [link]. Happy to work around your schedule.

[Name]

08 · Expert source introduction

NO NEWS NEEDED · RELATIONSHIP BUILDING

Subject: Source for future [beat] stories

Hi [First name],

No pitch today. I work with [Expert], who [credential]. If you are ever writing about [topics 1, 2, 3] and need someone to explain the mechanics or sanity-check a claim, they are happy to help, on or off the record.

A recent example of how they explain things: [link].

[Name]

09 · Customer story pitch

TO TRADE OR VERTICAL PRESS

Subject: How [customer] [specific result]

Hi [First name],

[Customer, a type of org your readers know] [changed what, with what result, over what time]. [Customer contact, title] is willing to talk on the record about [what they tried before and why it failed].

We are the vendor involved, so I understand if you would prefer to speak only to them. Shall I connect you?

[Name]

10 · Trend pitch

OFFER MULTIPLE SOURCES, NOT JUST YOURS

Subject: [Trend] : [N] founders on why [shift]

Hi [First name],

We are seeing [trend, with one piece of evidence]. I can connect you with [Founder] plus [1 to 2 non-competing voices: a customer, an investor, an analyst] who see the same thing from different seats.

Would a short call help if you are planning anything on [topic]?

[Name]

11 · Follow-up

3 TO 4 BUSINESS DAYS LATER · ONCE

Subject: Re: [original subject]

Hi [First name],

One addition since my note: [new fact: customer on record, a number, an available time slot, an image].

If this is not a fit, a quick "not for me" is welcome and I will not chase.

[Name]

Reply in the same thread so they have context. Never "just bumping this to the top of your inbox".

12 · Thank you

SAME DAY THE PIECE RUNS

Subject: Thank you, [article title]

Hi [First name],

Thank you for the piece. [One specific thing you appreciated: the framing, the context, a detail they found]. We have shared it with [our community / customers].

If you are working on [related topic] later, [Founder] is always happy to help, with or without a story in it for us.

[Name]

Do not ask for corrections in a thank-you note. If there is a factual error, send a separate, short, polite note with the correct fact and a source.

● NEXT STEP

Want a senior operator *on your launch?*

Templates get you organised. Coverage, citations and pipeline come from judgement: which angle a journalist will actually take, which channel deserves the next dollar, and what to cut.

Book a 30-minute teardown. Bring your launch plan, your positioning or your last campaign and leave with a prioritised list of fixes.

Book a 30-minute teardown: shilikajain.com/contact

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